



BETH:
The IMPORTANCE *of*
THINKING AHEAD

When Beth Kramer's father died suddenly of a heart attack, she was ten, her sister was fourteen, and their mother, who had gone from her parents' home to marriage, had no idea how to manage the household accounts.

Fortunately, the house was nearly paid for and the family car still had some life in it. But Mrs. Kramer had been raised with the assumption that she would become a wife and mother, so she had not gone to college or acquired any other training and had no job experience to fall back on. Her late husband's small pension would take care of the house payment, but not much else.

Beth and her sister had known the comforts of middle-class living. Both girls had received allowances that were sufficient for them to enjoy the same pleasures their friends and classmates had, and though their lifestyle was modest, they never wanted for anything and never felt that their friends had more than they did. The family took a vacation every year, traveling from their home in Pennsylvania to visit family in Indiana, and had once gone to Disney World.